PROGRESSION · TIMELINE · STRUCTURE

authority-chain

Provenance chain — statute to regulation to guidance to case, walked in order.

The chain descends from statute to practice.

STATUTE

15 U.S.C. §6501

Congress, 1998 — verifiable parental consent for under-13 data.

REGULATION

16 C.F.R. Part 312

FTC implementing rule; 2013 rewrite expanded covered identifiers.

GUIDANCE

FTC Six-Step Compliance Plan

Staff guidance — non-binding, but cited in every consent order.

CASE

In re Epic Games · 2022

$245M consent order — operationalized "actual knowledge" standard.

branching forks the chain where authority splits.

STATUTE

- `15 U.S.C. §6501` COPPA, 1998
- `16 C.F.R. Part 312` FTC implementing rule
- `FTC Six-Step Compliance Plan` staff guidance
- `In re Epic Games · 2022` $245M consent order
- `In re YouTube/Google · 2019` $170M consent order

trail walks the chain as a breadcrumb.

01

STATUTE

15 U.S.C. §6501

Verifiable parental consent for under-13 data.

02

REGULATION

16 C.F.R. Part 312

FTC implementing rule.

03

GUIDANCE

FTC Six-Step Plan

Cited in every consent order.

04

CASE

Epic Games · 2022

$245M consent order.

pyramid weights the tiers by force.

STATUTE

15 U.S.C. §6501

Congress, 1998 — consent for under-13 data.

REGULATION

16 C.F.R. Part 312

FTC implementing rule.

GUIDANCE

FTC Six-Step Plan

Staff guidance, non-binding.

CASE

In re Epic Games · 2022

$245M consent order.

bracket groups the tiers by actor.

TREATY	Charter of Fundamental Rights, Art. 8 EU primary law — protection of personal data is a fundamental right.
REGULATION	GDPR (EU) 2016/679 Directly applicable across all member states; sets the Art. 83 fine tiers.
GUIDANCE	EDPB Guidelines 04/2022 Harmonized methodology for calculating administrative fines.
DECISION	DPC v. Meta · 2023 €1.2B fine — the largest GDPR penalty to date.

Six tiers is the chain's ceiling.

STATUTE	15 U.S.C. §6501
REGULATION	16 C.F.R. 312
GUIDANCE	FTC guidance
ENFORCEMENT	Consent decrees
CASE LAW	Circuit reads
CONTRACT	DPAs — the stop

The chain descends from statute to practice.

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When NOT to reach for authority-chain.

Flat list of citations

If the rows have no tier hierarchy, use `list takeaway numbered` or `regulatory-update`. authority-chain earns its chrome only when the descent from statute to case is the point.

Missing citation chip

The inline-code citation is the row's anchor; without it the gloss reads as opinion. Always cite, even for guidance and case rows.

Out-of-order tiers

The chain reads as a descent: statute first, case last. Reversing it or skipping a tier breaks the metaphor the audience is using to follow you.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`regulatory-update` — period-bounded changelog rather than a single rule's lineage

`list` — `takeaway numbered`: flat enumeration of requirements without tier hierarchy

`list-steps` — the rows are procedural steps rather than authority tiers